

HABBINSON

PERSONALITY & ENTREPRENEURSHIP SCHOOL

— PARENT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

How to raise a child who dares

Want to raise a child who dares? See how Mary Kom boxed past every "you can't," plus 5 ways to grow a brave child who takes on challenges instead of shrinking from them.

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THE CHALLENGE PARENTS FACE

A child who dares is born partly, but mostly made — and most of us accidentally raise the opposite. We say "be careful" fifty times a day. We smooth every path and remove every risk. And without meaning to, we teach our kids that the safest thing is to never try the hard, scary, wonderful thing at all.

THE 30-SECOND ANSWER

How to raise a child who dares

QUICK ANSWER

How do I raise a child who dares? Let your child take safe risks and face small failures without rushing to rescue them. Praise their courage and effort, not just their wins, and model bravery yourself. Daring grows through supported challenge — a child who is allowed to try, stumble, and try again learns that fear is something to act through, not avoid.

WHAT THE RESEARCH SHOWS

“Harvard's research shows resilience is built, not inborn, grown through supported challenges rather than a problem-free childhood.

Sources: Harvard

DO THIS

5 ways to raise a child who dares

Work through these in order. Small, consistent reps beat one big push.

1**Let them try the "not for you" thing**

If they want to climb, sing, code, or box, back them — especially when others doubt it.

2**Praise courage over outcome**

Say "I love that you tried," not just "I love that you won."

3**Let small failures stand**

Resist rescuing; let them feel a setback and discover they're still fine.

4**Model your own brave tries**

Let them see you attempt something hard and stumble without shame.

5**Reframe nerves as readiness**

Teach them "butterflies mean this matters," not "butterflies mean stop."

— KEEP AN EYE OUT

What quietly makes a child play it safe

- ✓ Saying "be careful" constantly, until a child reads every new thing as dangerous.
- ✓ Jumping in to fix or rescue at the first wobble, so they never feel their own capability.
- ✓ Praising only safe success, so risk and failure start to feel shameful.
- ✓ Showing our own fear of judgement, teaching them to dread what others might think.

— COMMON QUESTIONS

Quick answers for parents

How do I raise a child who dares to take on challenges?

Let your child take safe risks and face small failures without instant rescue. Praise their courage and effort over their wins, back the bold things they want to try, and model bravery yourself. Daring grows through supported challenge, so each scary attempt makes the next one feel smaller.

Did Mary Kom really face opposition to boxing?

Yes. Mary Kom grew up in a poor family in Manipur and took up boxing despite the common belief that it wasn't for girls, limited money, and little early support. She trained with determination and became a six-time world champion and Olympic medallist — a powerful model of daring against the odds.

Is it bad to tell my child to "be careful" a lot?

Constant caution, though loving, can quietly teach a child that the world is dangerous and they're fragile. The occasional safety reminder is fine, but try swapping some "be carefuls" for "you've got this." Children grow bolder when we trust them to handle reasonable risks.

How do small failures help a child become braver?

Each survived failure proves to a child that a setback isn't the end of the world. A lost match or flubbed line, met with support rather than rescue, teaches them they can fall and recover. That lived experience is what builds the courage to try again and aim higher.

My child is naturally cautious — can they still learn to dare?

Yes. Courage is a skill, not a fixed trait. Start with small, supported challenges just beyond their comfort zone, praise the trying, and let them feel each success. A cautious child who is gently stretched and never shamed can grow remarkably bold over time.

How does daring help my child's future?

Almost everything valuable — new friendships, opportunities, leadership — sits on the far side of a brave first try. A child who learns to act through fear rather than avoid it gets more chances and bounces back faster. That daring habit becomes a lifelong advantage in school, work, and life.

READING HELPS. PRACTICE STICKS.

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